

HM 477 The English Novel: Form and History

Course Placement: The English Novel is an Open Elective (HSS) for VI & VIII Semester BTech Students

Course Format: 3 lectures per week

Course Content:

This is a reading-intensive course. We will read 3–4 novels from the 18th, 19th and the 20th centuries, classics of the English speaking world in the context of the social, political and economic conditions in which they were written. We will consider the impact of these conditions especially on the formal elements of the novel in the different phases of its development.

The readings for the course will tentatively be selected from the following set of texts: Daniel Defoe's *Robinson Crusoe*, Jane Austen's *Emma* / *Pride and Prejudice* / *Mansfield Park*, Charles Dickens' *Great Expectations* / *David Copperfield*, Joseph Conrad's *Heart of Darkness*, E. M. Forster's *A Passage to India* and Salman Rushdie's *Midnight's Children*.

Course Outcomes:

- Recognise the connection between literary form and the context in which texts are produced.
- Develop the ability to recognise and analyse the narrative techniques employed in texts.
- Develop an understanding of concepts like imperialism, colonialism, enlightenment, realism, modernism, postmodernism, postcolonialism

Assessment Method: 1 assignment and 2 exams and marks for class participation (the mode of assessment is subject to change)

Attendance Requirement: 70% attendance compulsory

Lecture Schedule

	Text	Topics	Weeks
1	Daniel Defoe, <i>Robinson Crusoe</i>	Finding a Voice/Forming a Centre: Rise of the novel form / fiction, Rise of Capitalism, Imperialism, Realism	2-3
2	Jane Austen / Charles Dickens	Absolute Omniscience/Consolidating the Centre: Omniscient Narration, Free Indirect Discourse, Closure, bildungsroman, novel of	2-3

		manners, Causal Plot	
3	Joseph Conrad / E. M. Forster	Enfeebled Voice/The Centre Struggles to Hold: Breakdown of values, no closure	2-3
4	Salman Rushdie, <i>Midnight's Children</i>	Metanarrative/The Centre Folds: Meaninglessness, return to the picaresque mode	2-3